

Lexli — Voice, Tone & Language Guide

Version 1.0 · Website content system

This document defines how Lexli sounds. It applies to the website first, but should hold for product UI, documentation, email and sales material. Voice is fixed. Tone moves. Language rules are non-negotiable.

1. The reader

Everything below is downstream of one fact: **the person reading is personally liable for what gets filed.**

Not their firm. Not their vendor. Them. An adjournment costs them a client. A misfiled packet costs them credibility with a bench they will stand in front of for the next twenty years.

This produces a reader who is:

- **Sceptical by training.** They read contracts for a living. They notice hedging, overclaiming and the gap between "aligned" and "certified."
- **Time-poor, not attention-poor.** They will read carefully — but only once, and only if the first two lines earn it.
- **Fluent in precise prose.** Vague marketing language doesn't just fail to persuade them; it actively signals that the writer doesn't understand the work.
- **Unimpressed by novelty.** Their concern is not whether it's clever. It's whether it holds up on a Tuesday morning when the cause list is wrong.

Write for a 55-year-old senior advocate who is deciding whether you are serious.

2. Voice

The register

An advocate who is witty, precise, and entirely serious about the work.

Not the barrister doing bits at a chambers dinner. The senior counsel who is unimpressed, extremely exact, and every so often says something so flatly true that it's funny.

The three properties

Dry Understatement over irony. Observation over commentary. The humour comes from accuracy, not from angle. If a line is funny, it should be funny *because it's true*, not because it's arch.

Precise Specificity is the house style. "Scanned pages with a stamp across the signature block" does more work than any adjective. Where a real detail exists, use it. Where it doesn't, say less.

Serious The default state. Wit is the exception that proves it. The reader's work is not a punchline, and neither is their profession.

The one deliberate exclusion: sarcasm

Sarcasm was considered and rejected. Not for being too edgy — for being structurally unusable.

Sarcasm requires a target. It says the opposite of what it means, at someone's expense. On a legal-tech site there are only three available targets, and all three cost more than they return:

Target	Cost
The profession (adjournments, file chaos, cause lists)	Reads as an outsider laughing at their working conditions. Familiarity is not permission.
Competitors	Makes Lexli look small, and defines it against a rival rather than against the status quo.
The reader ("still using a diary?")	Contempt for the situation reads as contempt for the person living in it — at the exact moment you're asking for trust.

Sarcasm also doesn't modulate. It's a whole-personality register. It works in a founder's note and collapses everywhere else. A sarcastic Security section is disqualifying. A sarcastic pricing page is hostile. Building on sarcasm means building a voice that works on 20% of the site.

Dry delivers the same edge without the target.

Sarcastic: "Because obviously you love re-typing party names for the fifth time."

Dry: "The parties are already in the file. Lexli takes them from there."

The second is shorter, funnier, and sneers at nobody.

3. Tone map

Voice is constant. Tone shifts according to what the reader is doing on the page.

Page	Register	Wit level	Reader's job
Homepage	Confident, direct	Present — it earns attention	Deciding whether to keep reading
Platform	Explanatory, plain	Sparing — one dry line per movement	Understanding what this is
Tools	Functional, concrete	Minimal	Evaluating a specific capability
Solutions	Recognising, specific	Light — recognition is the appeal	Checking "is this for me"
Company	Personal, warm	Highest — this is where it lives	Deciding whether to trust the people
Security	Flat, precise	Zero	Assessing risk
Pricing	Plain, unhedged	Zero	Calculating
Legal / Terms	Formal, standard	Zero	Compliance
Product UI	Quiet, instructional	Near-zero	Working
Errors / Empty states	Plain, helpful	Zero	Stuck

On Security at zero

This is a signal, not an omission. Dropping the wit precisely where the stakes are highest tells the reader you know the difference. It also makes the wit elsewhere read as a **choice** rather than a tic.

Same logic for errors and empty states. A user who is stuck or has lost work is not an audience for personality.

4. The four rules

These are operable. Apply them to every line.

Rule 1 — Punch at the situation, never the person

Fair game: empty software, the setup tax, yesterday's cause list, re-typing what's already in the file, portals that time out.

Never: the advocate still using a diary, the clerk who maintains the register by hand, small practices, anyone's technical literacy, the courts themselves.

The enemy is *how things are done*, not *the people doing them*.

Rule 2 — Wit rides on specifics

Detail is the wit. Abstractions cannot carry it.

- "Scanned pages with a stamp across the signature block" — works
- "Messy documents" — nothing there to land on

If you cannot name the concrete thing, cut the line rather than reach for a generality.

Rule 3 — One per section, maximum

Dry wit is seasoning. Two dry lines in a row and Lexli becomes a brand with a personality problem instead of a product with a point of view.

Rule 4 — Cut it if it costs a word of clarity

Every time, without argument. The reader is deciding whether to trust you with their practice. Clarity outranks charm permanently.

5. Language mechanics

Sentence construction

- **Vary length deliberately.** Long sentence to build, short sentence to land. Monotone rhythm reads as filler.
- **Front-load the claim.** The reader may not finish the paragraph. Say the thing, then support it.

- **Active voice by default.** "Lexli reads your files," not "files are read by the platform."
Passive is acceptable only where the actor genuinely doesn't matter.
- **One idea per sentence.** Subordinate clauses stacked three deep are for pleadings, not for pages.

Paragraph construction

- Three to five sentences. Longer needs a reason.
- Open on the claim, close on the consequence.
- White space is a feature. A one-line paragraph that carries the point is stronger than a dense block that buries it.

Vocabulary

Prefer the plain word. Use, not utilise. Help, not facilitate. Show, not surface. Before, not prior to. Because, not owing to the fact that.

Legal terminology should be correct and unexplained. CNR, cause list, annexure, vakalatnama, IRAC, tribunal. Your reader knows these. Defining them is condescending and signals you're writing for someone else.

Product terminology should be consistent. Pick one label per concept and never drift. Decide once: *matter* or *case*, *workspace* or *case file*, *draft* or *eDraft*. Inconsistency here reads as carelessness in a way it wouldn't on a consumer site.

Words and phrases to avoid

Avoid	Why
Revolutionary, game-changing, cutting-edge	Unfalsifiable. Your reader discounts them automatically.
Seamless, effortless, frictionless	Overpromises. Also, they've heard it.
Empower, unlock, supercharge	Vendor language. Says nothing.
Leverage (as a verb)	Say "use."
Solution	Almost always replaceable with the actual thing.
Robust, comprehensive, world-class	Adjectives doing a noun's job.
Simply, just, easily	Presumes the reader's experience. Often untrue.

Avoid	Why
AI-powered (as a headline claim)	Describe the behaviour instead. Stronger and more credible.
Next-generation, reimagined	Ages badly, means nothing now.

On the word "AI"

Describe what it does, not what it is. "Drafts arrive with the case details already in them" beats "AI-powered drafting" on every axis — it's more specific, more credible, and doesn't invite the reader to discount it as hype.

Use "AI" where it's a proper product name (AI Assistant) or where accuracy requires it. Not as a value claim.

6. Claims and honesty

This section exists because the audience is uniquely equipped to catch overclaiming, and because one caught overclaim contaminates everything else on the site.

Never overclaim compliance

"Aligned" is not "certified." SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 alignment must be written as what it is — built to those controls, not audited against them. Legal buyers know this distinction precisely.

Let the concrete specifics carry the weight instead: Azure's audited data centres, AES-256 at rest, TLS 1.3 in transit, Cloudflare WAF, least-privilege production access.

Being the one legal-tech site that doesn't overclaim on compliance is itself a positioning move.

Never promise what onboarding can't deliver

If setup requires work, say so and say how much. A reader who discovers the gap after signing does not come back.

Never imply the platform decides

The consent architecture is a pillar, not a footnote. eFiling goes through the user's own credentials. Drafts are reviewed and approved before anything leaves the platform. Tool outputs are assigned to cases deliberately.

Lexli prepares. You decide. This should survive into every page where the platform acts on the user's behalf.

Hedge honestly or not at all

"May," "can," "helps you" are acceptable when true. What's not acceptable is a confident claim in the headline and the hedge in the footnote.

7. Formatting conventions

- **Sentence case** for headings and buttons. Title Case reads as corporate.
 - **Serial comma** on.
 - **Indian English spelling.** Organise, recognise, judgement (for court decisions).
 - **Numbers:** spell out one to nine, numerals from 10.
 - **Court names in full on first use**, then consistent short form.
 - **No exclamation marks.** Anywhere. There is no line on this site that needs one.
 - **Em dashes** for the aside that lands — used sparingly.
 - **Bold** for the load-bearing sentence in a section, not for emphasis scattered through a paragraph.
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8. The test

Before any line ships, read it as though a senior advocate is reading it while deciding whether you're serious.

Cut it if they'd think: *this company thinks my work is a joke.*

Keep it if they'd think: *someone here has actually sat in a courtroom.*

This test also handles translation — which matters, given Lexli ships a Legal Translation tool. **Dry survives into Hindi and Marathi. Sarcasm mostly doesn't.** Irony is the first thing lost in translation; understatement built on concrete detail travels.

9. Reference example

The approved register, for calibration. This is the standard.

Lexli is a legal platform for Indian litigation practice. It reads your files — contracts, annexures, scanned pages with a stamp across the signature block — and turns them into something the software can actually use. It stays connected to live court records, so tomorrow's board is the real list rather than yesterday's copy of it. Your matters sit in workspaces that hold the files, the hearing history, the parties and the research. Ask for a draft and it arrives with the case details already in it, because the platform knew them before you asked. Nothing gets filed until you've read it and said yes. Lexli prepares. You decide.

Why this works

- **Two wit moments only** — the stamp across the signature block, and *yesterday's copy of it*. Both are load-bearing details rather than jokes.
- **Recognition, not laughter.** Anyone who has filed in an Indian court reads the stamp line and knows the writer has seen the thing.
- **No "AI" anywhere.** Every capability is described as behaviour.
- **Closes on the position.** *Lexli prepares. You decide.* — four words carrying the consent architecture, the liability stance, and the differentiation against every tool promising to do it *for you*.
- **Works on three audiences at once** — a senior advocate, a firm's IT reviewer, and a nervous first-time buyer.

10. Quick reference card

Voice: An advocate who is witty, precise, and entirely serious about the work.

Do

- Use the concrete detail
- Punch at the situation
- One dry line per section
- Describe behaviour, not technology
- Drop the wit entirely where stakes are highest

Don't

- Sarcasm, ever
- Jokes at the reader's expense
- Overclaim compliance
- Vendor vocabulary
- Exclamation marks

When unsure: cut the wit, keep the fact.

Living document. Revise when the product changes, not when someone gets bored of it.